

Osaid Khan

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Dear Hiring Team,

I am submitting my candidacy for the AI Platform and Applications Engineer role with NED. I bring software engineering and AI research experience across production backend services, secure AI-powered applications, RAG pipelines, model-serving experiments, evaluation workflows, and operational support. That background aligns closely with NED's need for a builder-operator who can translate practical use cases into reliable internal tools while helping steward a secure AI application platform.

At Sperse, I designed secure AI-powered applications and core platform services for CRM copilots using LangGraph, LangChain, FastAPI, and Langfuse observability. I also refactored 500+ backend operations into model access and routing dispatchers for model endpoints, inference routing, and task-scoped tools, replacing 60+ REST tools with tool calling, structured outputs, and API contracts. For retrieval-heavy workflows, I built LlamaIndex RAG pipelines and retrieval services for enterprise search and question answering using document processing, parsing, chunking, metadata enrichment, embeddings, indexing, vector search, and ranking strategies, improving tool selection accuracy by 90%. Those same patterns map directly to NED's application delivery responsibilities: reliable AI copilots, APIs, workflow integrations, grounding strategies, and maintainable application-layer services.

My AI research and earlier platform engineering experience strengthen the operational side of this role. At Pace Artificial Intelligence Lab, I built an agent-evaluation pipeline with LLM judges and reward models to measure answer quality, groundedness, reliability, and operational performance; implemented LangGraph offline evaluation workflows that increased tool-call success by 50%; and supported vLLM and Hugging Face Transformers model-serving experiments with technical documentation and runbooks. At Qualitest, I built deployment pipelines with GitHub Actions, Docker, Git, CI/CD, and containerized deployment practices; orchestrated AWS Step Functions, Lambda, and CloudWatch workflows across 100K+ weekly executions; and supported Linux-based environment operations, application observability, application monitoring, troubleshooting, production support, and root-cause analysis across APIs.

NED's mission to strengthen democratic institutions around the world, and its belief that freedom is a universal human aspiration, are a strong match for the kind of engineering work I want to do. I am especially drawn to the values stated in NED's careers materials: Excellence, Respect, Empathy, Accountability, and Adaptability. I would bring those values to cross-functional work with IT, business partners, security, governance, and infrastructure stakeholders while delivering AI tools that are useful, traceable, and maintainable in support of NED's mission.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience can support NED's AI platform and applications work. I can be reached at +1 (945) 304-5781 or khanosaid726@gmail.com. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,
Osaid Khan